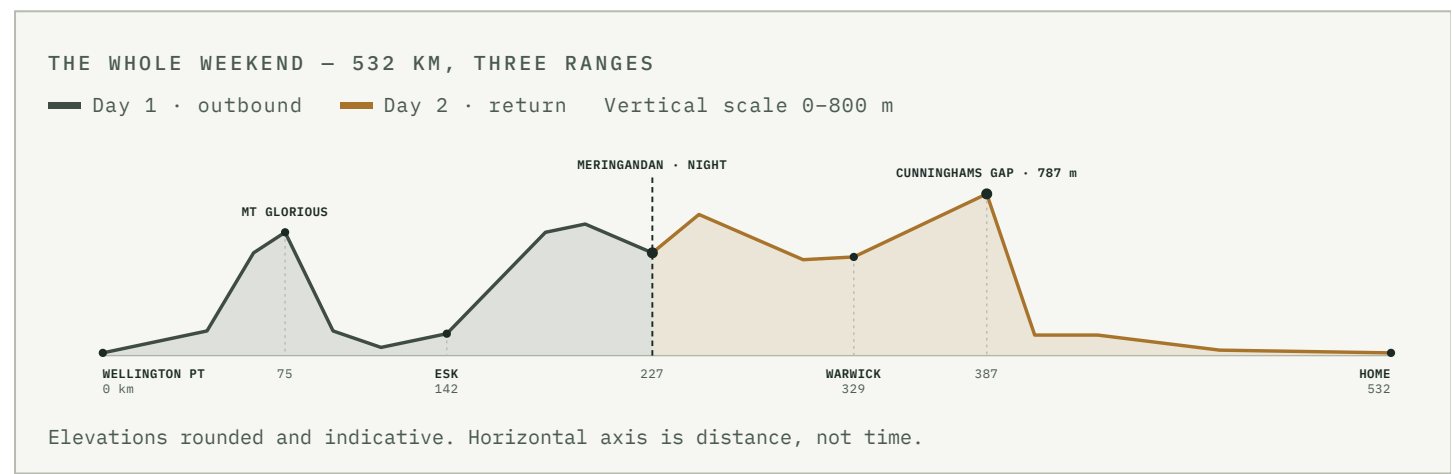


WELLINGTON POINT → MERINGANDAN → CUNNINGHAMS GAP

Three range crossings and no repeated roads. D'Aguilar on the way out, Ravensbourne into the Downs, and the Main Range at Cunninghams Gap on the way home.

DAY 1	DAY 2	ROLL / ARRIVE	OUT / HOME	FUEL STOPS
227 km	305 km	09:00 / 15:00	10:00 / 16:15	2



0 km 09:00	■ Main Road, Wellington Point — full tank Fill before you leave and that's the last pump you need until Highfields, 227 km away. Preload and rear damping set for two-up and luggage before you roll, not at the first stop. Don't leave earlier. This is a Friday and you're heading into town in the peak direction. 09:00 puts you on the Gateway at the tail of the rush; 08:00 puts you in the middle of it. Later is better than earlier here.
3	↗ Birkdale Road, west
10	↗ Manly Road → Wynnum Road, west
17	↗ Gateway Motorway (M1) north Over the Gateway Bridge. Toll — check the bike is on the account.
27	↗ Exit at Toombul onto Sandgate Road, south
33	↗ Lutwyche Road → Kelvin Grove Road → Musgrave Road
38 09:45	↗ Waterworks Road, west through Ashgrove
43	The Gap — straight through You don't need the servo this time. Keep rolling.

Alternative:

Stafford Road to Samford Road, out through Samford Village and up Mount Glorious Road from the north. Fewer lights, but you skip the whole Mt Nebo section.

B

D'AGUILAR RANGE — NEBO TO GLORIOUS

43 – 75 km • 09:55

45 | Waterworks Road becomes Mount Nebo Road

Past Walkabout Creek and Enoggera Reservoir. Climb starts immediately — tight, shaded, patchy surface.

46+ | ▲ Heavy enforcement corridor

One of the most policed motorcycle roads in the state, with 60 km/h zones through both villages and units at the lookouts. Ride it for the corners, not the numbers.

52 | Jolly's Lookout turn-off, left

Optional 1 km detour. Good early view east if Lea wants photos before the light flattens.

62 | Mount Nebo village — slow through

Road continues as Mount Glorious Road.

75 | ■ Mount Glorious — coffee, 30 minutes

10:00

Both cafés are open on a Friday: Mount Glorious Cafe from 7:30, The View from 8:30 (it's shut Mondays and Tuesdays, not today). Away by 10:30.

A Friday is the best day to ride this road. No weekend bike packs, no cyclist bunches on the climb, and school term means no holiday traffic either.

C

NORTHBROOK DESCENT TO THE VALLEY

75 – 115 km • 10:30

78 | ▲ Steep descent — Mount Glorious Road becomes Northbrook Parkway

The technical section of the day. Tight switchbacks under closed canopy that stay damp long after rain, with leaf litter on the inside lines. This is where a pillion feels rough throttle and brake inputs most — brake early and let it run.

95 | Opens into fast sweepers toward Lake Wivenhoe

The reward. Good sightlines, gentle radii, easy two-up cruising.

108 | Wivenhoe Dam / Split Yard Creek turn-off, right

Optional, adds about 20 minutes. You have the slack for it if Mt Glorious ran short.

115 | ↗ Brisbane Valley Highway — turn right (north)

11:10

Fernvale is a short run left if you want a leg stretch. Otherwise straight north for Esk.

D

BRISBANE VALLEY HIGHWAY

115 – 142 km • 11:10

- 128 | **Coominya turn-off – stay on the highway**
Open, straight, 100 km/h. Nothing to think about.

- 142 | **■ Esk – lunch, 45 minutes**
11:35 | Ipswich Street. Esk Bakery & Cafe from 6:00 weekdays, 7:00 Sunday. Away by 12:20 to hold the 3pm check-in.

E

OVER THE GREAT DIVIDE – ESK-HAMPTON ROAD

142 – 199 km • 12:20

- 142 | **📍 In Esk, turn left off the Brisbane Valley Highway onto Esk-Hampton Road**
Signposted Hampton / Toowoomba. Easy to overshoot if you're still thinking about the bakery.

- 150 | **Redbank Creek – first of the crossings**

- 165 | **▲ Perseverance Creek – culvert replacement, side track in use**
A failing culvert is being replaced with a temporary two-lane side track alongside, so the road stays open. Expect gravel edges, a rough transition at each end and reduced limits.
Friday means crews on site. You'll hit this around 12:45 on a working weekday, so assume live traffic control and a stop/slow wait rather than a clear run. Budget ten minutes and check QLDTraffic over breakfast.

- 172 | **▲ Rainforest climb – damp, cambered, adverse in places**
Best road of the day and the one that punishes optimism. Shaded corners hold moisture and the camber falls away on a couple of the tighter lefts.

- 183 | **■ Ravensbourne – National Park Road detour, left**
13:20 | Short run in to one of the better Lockyer Valley views. Toilets and picnic tables. 15 minutes.

- 199 | **Hampton – New England Highway**
13:50 | Toilets at the visitor information centre, café opposite. Quick stop only from here on.

Crows Nest: 12 km north of Hampton, motorcycle-friendly pub doing lunch to 2pm. It's a 24 km round trip and it won't fit alongside the Ravensbourne stop if you want to be at the Airbnb by three. Pick one.

F

DOWN TO MAIN STREET

199 – 227 km · 14:05

199	Turn left (south) onto the New England Highway (A3)
212	Through Geham – stay on the A3
222 14:35	■ Highfields – fill the tank, then turn right (west) onto Meringandan Road The one fuel stop that matters. Fill here and tomorrow's 305 km start on a full tank with no morning detour. Last real shops too.
227 14:50	■ Main Street, Meringandan – Airbnb opposite the pub Meringandan Road runs into Highfields Road and then Main Street, about 5 km. Ten minutes in hand on a 3pm check-in. Bike parked, gear off, pub is a walk across the road – no reason to be careful with the second beer. Book a table. Friday is the big night at a country pub with that reputation, and people drive out from Toowoomba for it. Call ahead on 07 4696 7146 rather than turning up at seven and waiting.

A

ACROSS THE DOWNS TO WARWICK

0 – 102 km · 10:00

0 km 10:00	■ Saturday check-out, Main Street, Meringandan Zero the trip. Tank's already full from yesterday, so you can leave straight down Meringandan Road without backtracking to Highfields.
19 10:25	Toowoomba — Meringandan Road runs in via Harlaxton Optional: Picnic Point off Tourist Road for the view down the range you're deliberately not riding today. 20 minutes.
25	↗ New England Highway (A3) south, through Drayton
44	Cambooya Big-sky Downs country from here. Long open curves, cropping either side, almost no traffic on a Sunday morning. A completely different kind of riding to yesterday.
62	Nobby Rudd's Pub, the Steele Rudd connection. Worth a photo stop if you're running early.
72	Clifton
84	Allora Heritage main street, and the last town before Warwick.
102 12:00	■ Warwick — fuel and lunch, 45 minutes Well inside range on a 400 km tank, but 102 km in is the sensible place to top up before the Gap. Away by 12:45.

B

MAIN RANGE — CUNNINGHAMS GAP

102 — 180 km · 12:45

102	↗ Leave Warwick east on the Cunningham Highway (A15) Signposted Ipswich / Brisbane.
118	▲ Gladfield onwards — pavement strengthening works A staged resurfacing programme between the Gladfield rest area and the Gap started mid-2026 and runs progressively over several years. Crews work weekdays, so a Saturday should be clear of stop/slow — but the surface changes, loose edges and temporary seal are there regardless of the day.
160 13:35	■ Cunninghams Gap — crest at 787 m Highest point of the weekend. The reconstruction after the 2019 bushfires is finished: the slope above the road is stabilised, the grade at the crest eased, and — the part that matters to you — the old guardrail has been replaced with motorcycle protection rail through the cutting. Carpark at the crest, 15 minutes.
162	Eastern descent — the best five kilometres of the day Rainforest either side, consistent radii, good surface, and it drops you out of the Great Dividing Range for the last time this weekend.
180 14:05	Aratula — fuel if you skipped Warwick

C

FASSIFERN VALLEY

180 — 250 km · 14:05

188	↗ Turn right onto Boonah–Fassifern Road Gets you off the Cunningham before it turns into a truck route. Flat, fast, with the Main Range escarpment filling the mirrors.
200 14:20	■ Boonah — last coffee, 20 minutes Good country main street and an easy final stop before the run into town.
200	↗ Ipswich–Boonah Road north, through Peak Crossing Rolling farmland, light traffic, 80–100 km/h. Pleasant rather than exciting, which is about right for the end of a two-day ride.
250 15:30	Ipswich

250 | ➤ Ipswich Motorway (M2) east

270 | ➤ Gateway Motorway (M1)

285 | ➤ Exit at Old Cleveland Road, east

305 | ■ **Capalaba → Wellington Point. Done.**
 16:15 532 km for the weekend, three range crossings, and not one road ridden twice.

If you want more: from Boonah, run the Boonah–Beaudesert Road east instead, then Beaudesert to Mount Cotton Road and home through the Redlands back way. Adds roughly 40 km and a decent set of corners, at the cost of arriving closer to five.

FUEL PLAN

- **Before you leave:** full tank at Wellington Point.
- **Day 1:** no stop required. 227 km on a 400 km tank leaves 170 km spare, even riding it hard two-up.
- **Highfields, 222 km:** fill on arrival so Sunday starts full.
- **Day 2:** Warwick at 102 km. Not strictly needed for 305 km, but it's the natural lunch stop and it removes any doubt.
- Backups: Aratula and Boonah both have fuel.

FLAGGED HAZARDS

- **Perseverance Creek, D1 165 km** — culvert works, side track, gravel edges.
- **Mt Nebo / Mt Glorious, D1** — heavy enforcement, 60 zones.
- **Northbrook Parkway, D1 78 km** — damp switchbacks under canopy.
- **Gladfield to the Gap, D2 118 km** — staged pavement works, changing surfaces.

THE CLOCK

- **Friday:** roll 09:00, arrive 14:50. About 30 minutes of slack built in — and on a Friday you'll want it for the Perseverance Creek hold.
- If the works run long, drop the Ravensbourne detour. Everything else is fixed.
- Crows Nest doesn't fit on a Friday. Leave it.
- **Saturday:** out at 10:00, home about 16:15. Longer day, easier riding, no works crews.

LATE OCTOBER

- **Storm season has started.** Late spring afternoons in south-east Queensland build cells over the ranges from about 2pm. Both days you're at altitude in exactly that window.
- Check the BOM radar before the Ravensbourne climb on Friday and before the Gap on Saturday. A 20-minute wait under an awning beats a wet rainforest descent two-up.
- Warm days, cool mornings. The Downs sit at 500–700 m and Meringandan can still be single figures at dawn.
- Sunset is around 18:05, no daylight saving. Both days finish comfortably in daylight.

- Spring means more roos about – but your riding hours are mid-day, which is the low-risk window.

TWO-UP NOTES

- Preload and rear damping set for the extra weight before departure.
- Stops land at roughly 45-60 minute intervals both days. Keep them.
- Northbrook and Ravensbourne are the two sections where smooth inputs matter most.
- Both mornings will be cold in the range shade even when the valleys are warm – the Downs sit at 500-700 m.

Distances are map estimates, indicative rather than surveyed – expect ± 5 km against the trip meter, and treat the odometer column as a running guide. Clock times assume a relaxed two-up pace with the stops listed and no significant delays. Road names verified where possible; the suburban sections at each end have several equally good alternatives, so use whatever the GPS prefers there. Confirm the Perseverance Creek and Cunninghams Gap works on QLDTraffic before each day – both are multi-year programmes and their status in late October may differ from what's described here.

Prepared 20 August 2026 for Friday 23 – Saturday 24 October 2026.